

OpenClaw Model Switching

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1. Course Content

This course will systematically introduce OpenClaw's model selection working mechanism and three model switching methods.

2. Temporary Session Model Switching

2.1 Open TUI Session

- Terminal input

```
openclaw tui
```

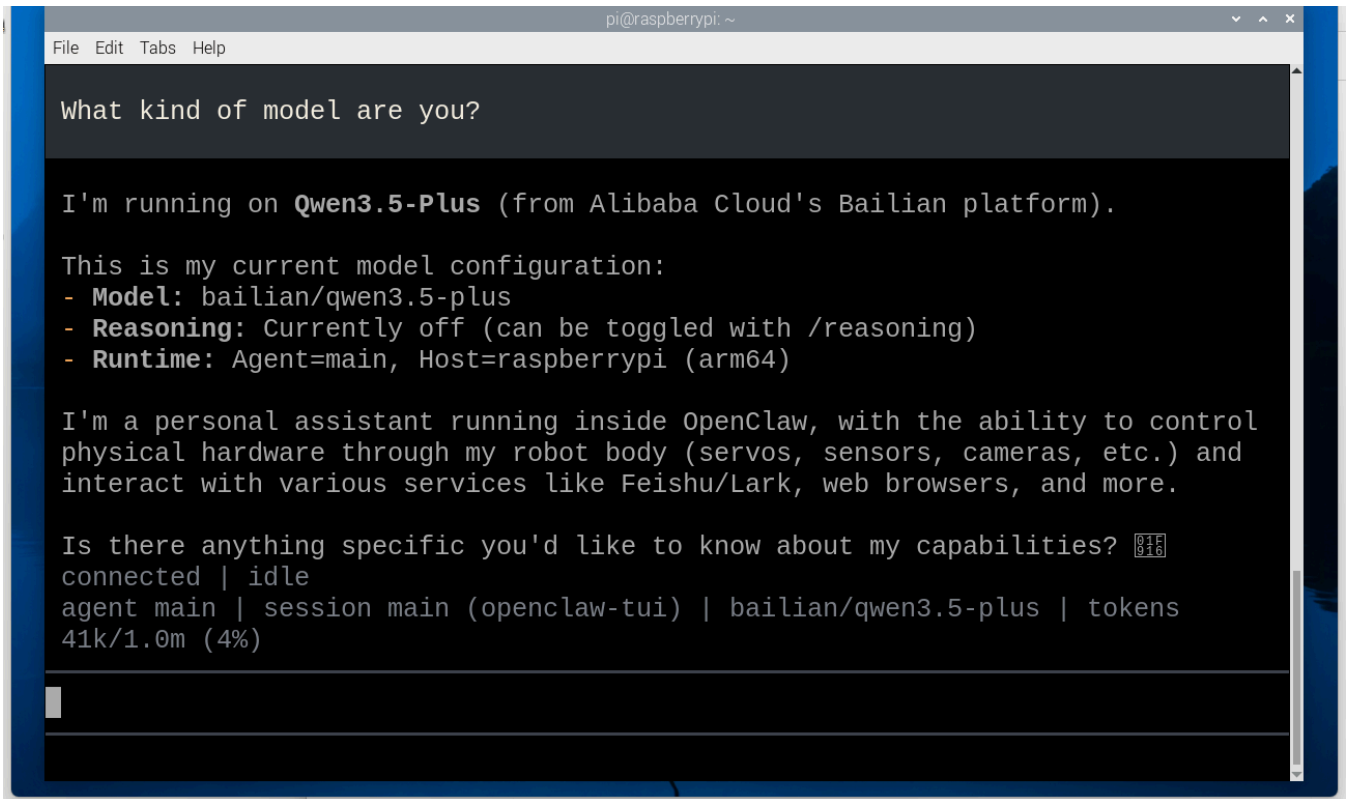
2.2 Use /model to Switch Session Model

Command	Description
<code>/model</code>	View available model list, select and switch model

- Enter `/model` in the session box and press Enter, use keyboard up/down keys to select a model, then press Enter to switch

```
search: >   

→ openrouter/openrouter/auto   Auto Router
openrouter/openrouter/free     Free Models Router
codingplan/qwen3.5-plus
codingplan/qwen3-max-2026-01-23
codingplan/qwen3-coder-next
codingplan/qwen3-coder-plus
codingplan/MiniMax-M2.5
codingplan/glm-5
codingplan/glm-4.7
1/25
```



3. Switch Default Model

3.1 Switch via CLI

The simplest way is to use the CLI command to directly set the default model:

- Here is an example of switching to `bailian/qwen3.6-plus` model

```
openclaw models set bailian/qwen3.6-plus
```

```
root@jetson-yahboom:~# openclaw models set bailian/qwen3.6-plus
OpenClaw 2026.3.8 (3caab92) - Built by lobsters, for humans. Don't question the hierarchy.
Config overwrite: /root/.openclaw/openclaw.json (sha256 481d9559615a43487b71b1063c804a16f8cb235bd9dc0349f113ea60b6c120e1 -> 77d09d5157428687dd260c2597b0585ce80e4bc4281a4116727d6458ec71902d, backup=/root/.openclaw/openclaw.json.bak)
Updated ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Default model: bailian/qwen3.6-plus
root@jetson-yahboom:~#
```

3.2 Switch via Configuration File

- Edit the `openclaw.json` configuration file to modify the Agent's default model

```
nano /root/.openclaw/openclaw.json
# Or use your favorite editor, such as vim, code, etc.
```

In `openclaw.json`, specify the default primary model through the `agents.defaults.model.primary` configuration item:

```
{
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.6-plus"
    }
  }
}
```

- Verify if the configuration takes effect:

```
openclaw models status
```

```
root@jetson-yahboom:~# openclaw models status
❯ OpenClaw 2026.3.8 (3caab92) – I don't sleep, I just enter low-power mode and dream of clean diffs.

Config      : ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Agent dir   : ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent
Default     : bailian/qwen3.6-plus
Fallbacks (0) : -
Image model : -
Image fallbacks (0) : -
Aliases (1) : openrouter -> openrouter/autot
Configured models (21): openrouter/autot, openrouter/openrouter/free, codingplan/qwen3.5-plus, codingplan/qwen3-max-2026-01-23, codingplan/qwen3-coder-next, codingplan/qwen3-coder-plus, codingplan/MiniMax-M2.5, codingplan/glm-5, codingplan/glm-4.7, codingplan/kimi-k2.5, bailian/qwen3.5-plus, bailian/qwen3.6-plus, bailian/qwen3.6-plus-2026-04-02, bailian/qwen3-vl-plus-2025-12-19, bailian/qwen3-vl-plus, bailian/qwen-vl-plus-latest, bailian/gui-plus, bailian/gui-plus-2026-02-26, ollama/deepseek-r1:1.5b, ollama/tinyllama:1.1b, ollama/qwen3:1.7b

Auth overview
Auth store   : ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent/auth-profiles.json
Shell env    : off
Providers w/ OAuth/tokens (1): bailian (1)
- bailian effective=profiles:~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent/auth-profiles.json | profiles=1 (oauth=0, token=1, api_key=0) | bailian:default=token:sk-d4084...f94a2838
- codingplan effective=models.json:sk-d4084...f94a2838 | models.json=sk-d4084...f94a2838 | source=models.json: ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent/models.json

OAuth/token status
- bailian
- bailian:default static
```

Note: When modifying the configuration file, be careful not to add commas or other symbols at the end of the configuration

4. Add Model Options List

- `agents.defaults.models` is the **allowlist/directory** that controls the range of usable models in OpenClaw. When this configuration item is set, users can only use models included in the list, and this list will serve as the model scope control basis for both the `/model` command and session overrides.

4.1 Add Model via Configuration File

Configure `agents.defaults.models` in `openclaw.json`, add models to be used to the allowlist:

```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
    },
    "models": {
      "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
      "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},

```

```

    "bailian/glm-4.7": {}
  },
  "workspace": "/home/pi/.openclaw/workspace",
  "compaction": {
    "mode": "safeguard",
    "memoryFlush": {
      "enabled": false
    }
  }
}

```

```

"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.6-plus"
    },
    "models": {
      "openrouter/auto": {
        "alias": "OpenRouter"
      },
      "openrouter/openrouter/free": {},
      "codingplan/qwen3.5-plus": {},
      "codingplan/qwen3-max-2026-01-23": {},
      "codingplan/qwen3-coder-next": {},
      "codingplan/qwen3-coder-plus": {},
      "codingplan/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
      "codingplan/glm-5": {},
      "codingplan/glm-4.7": {},
      "codingplan/kimi-k2.5": {},
      "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3.6-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3.6-plus-2026-04-02": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-v1-plus-2025-12-19": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-v1-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen-v1-plus-latest": {},
      "bailian/gui-plus": {},
      "bailian/gui-plus-2026-02-26": {},
      "ollama/deepseek-r1:1.5B": {},
      "ollama/tinyllama:1.1b": {},
      "ollama/qwen3:1.7b": {}
    },
    "workspace": "/root/.openclaw/workspace",
    "compaction": {
      "mode": "safeguard"
    },
    "maxConcurrent": 4,
    "subagents": {
      "maxConcurrent": 8
    }
  }
},

```

4.2 Model Reference Format Specification

In OpenClaw, all model references use a unified format:

```
provider/modelID
```

Examples:

Model Reference	Description
anthropic/claude-opus-4-6	Anthropic's Claude Opus model
anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6	Anthropic's Claude Sonnet model
openai/gpt-5.4	OpenAI's GPT-5.4 model
openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2	Case where model ID itself contains slashes

Note: If the model ID itself contains `/` (such as `moonshotai/kimi-k2`), you must provide the reference in the complete format `openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2`.

5. Appendix: CLI Command Quick Reference

Command	Purpose
openclaw onboard	Onboarding guide, helps quickly complete initial configuration
openclaw models list	View all configured model list
openclaw models status	View current model configuration status details
/model	View available model list in chat
/model status	View current model status details in chat